

The content engine you already have

Week 11, Lecture 2 · LangoBee to \$10K MRR

Summer 2026 · Operating a Solo Language App from Zero Revenue

What we'll cover

- The 17,440-video catalog as marketing inventory, not just product data
- Clip repurposing: the safe path and the risky one
- Programmatic SEO: catalog metadata as a long-tail keyword machine
- The Law of Shitty Clickthroughs: why owned channels beat rented ones
- What zero marginal cost actually means in practice

The catalog as inventory

You already have 17,440 pieces of content

Most pre-revenue products have to create content from scratch to feed a distribution channel.

LangoBee does not. Every text in the catalog is:

- Language-tagged
- Difficulty-scored (mean_zipf)
- Creator-attributed (2,773 creators)
- Topic-segmented (by creator category)
- Quality-gated (low-dialogue filter already running)

This metadata is the raw material for two distribution channels: social repurposing and programmatic SEO.

(June 2026 snapshot)

Two repurposing paths: safe and risky

Safe: screen-capture demos of your product playing the clip

You own the product interface. A recording of LangoBee's word-highlighting feed playing a Spanish cooking clip is your content. The underlying video is cited, not copied.

Risky: reposting the original clip verbatim

YouTube creators retain their rights. Reposting without permission is a copyright issue, not a gray area. The connection to week 10: partnered creators can give explicit permission; that is the deal structure.

For clips without a partnership agreement, the screen-capture path is the only safe one.

Programmatic SEO

What programmatic SEO is

Programmatic SEO is the creation of many keyword-targeted pages from a template plus structured data, at a scale that would be impossible to write manually.

Examples from other products:

- Zapier: one page per app integration (750,000+ pages, 1.6M organic visits/month) (Makosiewicz, 2023)
- Nomadlist: one page per city with structured travel data
- Wise: one page per currency pair

The pattern: find a repeating data structure that maps to a real search query. LangoBee has one.

(Law, 2023)

LangoBee's keyword structure

Every video in the catalog has at least three dimensions that map to search queries:

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language x topic x difficulty
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A Spanish cooking video at A2 difficulty answers the query:

"Spanish comprehensible input cooking videos for beginners"

A French current events video at B2 difficulty answers:

"Intermediate French news videos for language learners"

These are real queries with real monthly search volume and almost no competition from pages built on structured catalog data.

The Zapier analogy

Zapier's integration pages follow a template: "Connect [App A] to [App B]." Every page has the same structure, different data.

LangoBee's catalog page template: "Watch [Language] [Topic] videos at [Level]."

Each page gets:

- A title tag targeting the long-tail query
- A list of matching videos with difficulty scores
- One sample clip embedded (proof of value before signup)
- A signup CTA placed after the demo, not before it

This is product-led SEO: the page is a product experience, not a brochure. (Schwartz, 2021)

Why owned beats rented

The Law of Shitty Clickthroughs

Andrew Chen's 2012 observation: every marketing channel starts at high performance and decays toward near-zero over time.

The three drivers of decay:

1. Novelty fades: users tune out formats they have seen before
2. Competitors copy: what worked for you gets crowded
3. Audience scaling: the audience you reach expands beyond the early adopters who cared

A TikTok account you do not own is a rented channel. The algorithm controls distribution.

A catalog page you own is yours until the domain expires.

(Chen, 2012)

What "owned" means for LangoBee

An owned channel is one where you control the full stack: the URL, the content, the audience relationship.

- TikTok account: rented. The algorithm decides reach. A policy change ends distribution.
- YouTube channel: partially owned. You own the content; YouTube owns the discovery surface.
- Programmatic catalog pages: owned. Google indexes them; you control the content.
- Email list: owned. No platform between you and the reader.

The goal of distribution phase is not to rent as many channels as possible. It is to build one owned asset that compounds.

Zero marginal cost does not mean zero time cost

The catalog SEO pages can be generated programmatically. Once the template is built, adding a new language or topic costs nothing per page.

But the template has to be built. The slug structure has to be decided. The internal linking has to be set up. The pages have to be indexed.

This is not a weekend project. It is a two-week sprint that pays off over months as pages accumulate authority.

The correct framing: the content already exists. The engineering work is to make it discoverable.

SEO should be built into the product from day one, not bolted on afterward. The goal is to ask what the search user needs and answer it with proprietary product data that competitors cannot replicate.
(Paraphrased)

Eli Schwartz (2021)

Product-Led SEO at Agile100

The Bullseye test for these two channels

Week 9's Bullseye framework (Weinberg, 2015): run cheap tests on the two or three most promising channels before doubling down.

For week 11, the two candidates are:

- Owned social (TikTok/IG Reels/YT Shorts) fed by screen-capture demos
- Programmatic catalog SEO pages

A cheap test for social: three clips posted this week. Metric: impressions and share rate at 7 days.

A cheap test for SEO: five catalog pages published. Metric: indexed in Google within 30 days.

Neither requires new product infrastructure. Both run from the existing catalog.

Take-aways

1. The 17,440-video catalog is marketing inventory. The metadata already contains the raw material for both social repurposing and programmatic SEO.
2. Safe repurposing is screen-capture demos of your product in action. Reposting creator content without permission is a copyright issue, not a distribution strategy.
3. Programmatic SEO maps language x topic x difficulty to long-tail search queries that no competitor is targeting with structured catalog data.
4. Owned channels compound; rented channels decay. The Law of Shitty Clickthroughs applies to every platform you do not control.
5. The template has to be built once. After that, every new video import creates a new potential page at zero marginal cost.

What's next

- **Reading:** "Week 11: Owned loops and the content engine" at </c/langobee-10k-mrr-26su/readings/wk11>
- **Section this week:** Produce three clips through the pipeline; publish five catalog page stubs; define the loop metric dashboard
- **HW4 DUE this week:** Distribution channel audit, loop metric defined and baseline measured, one owned channel standing
- **Week 12:** Synthesis: the operating plan, kill criteria, and what \$10K MRR actually requires